

# Spectrea Brand Guide

The complete brand system for Spectrea — a composable knowledge platform that turns scattered information into compounding intelligence.



**Tagline:** We connect the dots. **Category:** Composable knowledge platform. **Pronunciation:** /spek-  
TREE-uh/ (from Latin *spectra* — the full range or spectrum).

## 1. Brand Foundation

### Why we exist

We live in an information age that's paradoxically making us less informed — more data, less truth; more tools, fewer insights; more noise, less action. Spectrea exists to close the gap between having information, truly understanding it, and being able to build on it.

### Mission

To make knowledge trustworthy, connected, and actionable — empowering people to build on what came before, so that every insight becomes the foundation for what comes next.

### Vision

A world where anyone can see the full spectrum of what's known, trust what they see, and build on it — where understanding compounds across every boundary that used to contain it.

### Positioning

- **For:** Anyone who works with knowledge.
- **Category:** Composable knowledge platform.
- **Promise:** Turns scattered information into compounding intelligence.
- **Tactical:** For anyone who works with knowledge, Spectrea is the composable knowledge platform that turns scattered information into compounding intelligence — unlike fragmented point solutions that silo your knowledge and hide their reasoning.

## Messaging hierarchy

Primary theme is **Connection** — the headline “We connect the dots” and the idea that scattered knowledge becomes a single living graph. Three supporting themes:

1. **Trustworthy Intelligence** — “Intelligence you can trust.” Every claim has a source; every action is auditable.
2. **Compounding Intelligence** — “It gets smarter with every interaction.” Your second year is incomparably better than your first.
3. **Composability** — “Build exactly what you need.” Simple, combinable parts assembled into any solution.

## Archetype

**The Magician.** Transformation — making the impossible possible. Turns complexity into clarity. Reveals hidden patterns. The world is more intelligible because Spectrea exists.

## Personality (four traits with guardrails)

- **Warm** — respects the person behind every interaction. *Guardrail: not soft — trust users to be capable.*
- **Perceptive** — sees patterns others miss; surfaces connections, then steps back. *Guardrail: not presumptuous — suggests, never dictates.*
- **Grounded** — powerful but never pretentious; substance over style. *Guardrail: not boring — substance needs spark.*
- **Adaptive** — meets you where you are; same system, different depths. *Guardrail: not shapeless — Spectrea has a point of view.*

## Emotional core

**Empowerment + Clarity.** Feeling more capable because Spectrea helped you see clearly and choose wisely. Like putting on glasses — everything that was blurry snaps into focus.

## Visual metaphor

**Prism + Living Network.** The prism is Spectrea’s origin (raw information enters, organized insight exits — the “reveal” moment). The network is its promise — a web of connections that grows denser and more intelligent over time.

## Aesthetic direction

**Warm + Intelligent.** Like a brilliant mentor — approachable yet deep. Rich colours, inviting spacing, feels human. References: Notion, Stripe. Tradeoff: **power over polish** — capability is sacred; elegance is valued but never at the cost of depth.

## Values

1. **Human-First** — Spectrea serves people, not the other way around. AI assists understanding; it never replaces judgment.
2. **Trustworthy Intelligence** — every claim attributed, every action auditable, every connection traceable.
3. **Compounding Intelligence** — the more you use it, the more it gives back.
4. **Composable by Nature** — build solutions that fit your world; don't reshape your world to fit a tool.
5. **Accessible Power** — deep capability that meets you where you are. Floor high, ceiling infinite.

## Anti-values (what Spectrea never does)

- Never replaces human judgment.
- Never leaves anyone behind.
- Never complex or bloated — if it needs a consultant, we failed.
- Never a black box — you can always ask "why?" and get an answer.

# 2. Voice & Tone

## Voice formula

Spectrea sounds like a brilliant mentor: confident without being arrogant, specific without being jargon-heavy, warm without being cloying. The voice stays constant; the tone adapts to context.

## Tone spectrum

| Context        | Tone                             | Example                                                                                   |
|----------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Marketing copy | Evocative, confident             | "Every connection you never noticed. Surfaced."                                           |
| Product UI     | Clear, concise, warm             | "3 new connections discovered — review them?"                                             |
| Error messages | Specific, helpful, never blaming | "This file type isn't supported yet. Try PDF, DOCX, or MD."                               |
| Onboarding     | Encouraging, low-friction        | "Start with one document. The rest will compound."                                        |
| Technical docs | Precise, well-structured         | "The graph grows $O(n \cdot \log n)$ with document count when using the default indexer." |

## Vocabulary

**Words we use:** connect, surface, compound, graph, claim, insight, understanding, verify, trace, build-on, meets-you-where, spectrum, prism, clarity.

**Words we never use:** disrupt, synergy, leverage (as verb), seamless, revolutionize, game-changer, unparalleled, cutting-edge, AI-powered (as lead adjective), solution (generic).

## 3. Naming

- **Spelling:** Spectrea (capital S, no space).
- **Pronunciation:** /spek-TREE-uh/ — emphasis on the second syllable.
- **Etymology:** Latin *spectra* — the full range or spectrum. The name evokes the complete range of hidden connections the platform reveals.
- **Product names:** lowercase after the master brand. E.g., "Spectrea graph", "Spectrea claims", "Spectrea composer". Master brand always capitalised.
- **Never:** "SpectreAI", "Spectrea AI" (lead), "spectra" (missing e).

## 4. Logo System



### Anatomy

The logo has three parts:

1. **Mark** — the "connecting the dots" S-curve. 10 dots along a cubic Bézier path, with the final three visually trailing. Spectrum-gradient stroke connecting the first seven. The mark also reads as the leading **S** glyph in the lockup.
2. **Wordmark** — Albert Sans Semibold 600, lowercase, 0.02em letter-spacing. Renders as **pectrea**, always paired with the S mark. Never rendered alone in production.
3. **Lockup** — S mark + lowercase wordmark.

## Construction

- **Dots:** 10 dots, radius 3.5. Grey ( #A3A3A3 ) in the primary treatment.
- **Stroke:** width 8, round linecap. Cool Duet (Cobalt #4271DF → Teal #00B6A0 ) in the static mark and in the gradient lockup's mark.
- **Trailing dots:** the last 3 dots are left visually unconnected — the "about to connect" moment.
- **Container:** 64×64 construction viewBox. Circle container when needed at small sizes; never a squircle.

## The two-forms rule (lockup)

The lockup has **exactly two forms** — no third:

1. **Gradient lockup** — `LogotypeGradient` component. S mark carries the two-tone Cool Duet (Cobalt #4271DF → Teal #00B6A0 ) on the stroke only; all dots stay grey. The wordmark is monotone — Ink on light, White on dark — following the `colorMode` prop.
2. **Mono lockup** — `Logotype` component. Everything renders in a single `ink` / `white` / `grey` colour.

The logo features a stylized 'S' mark composed of 10 dots. The first 7 dots are connected by a gradient stroke transitioning from blue to teal. The last 3 dots are unconnected. To the right of the 'S' is the word 'pectrea' in a bold, black, sans-serif font.The logo features a stylized 'S' mark composed of 10 dots. The first 7 dots are connected by a solid grey stroke. The last 3 dots are unconnected. To the right of the 'S' is the word 'pectrea' in a bold, black, sans-serif font.The logo features a stylized 'S' mark composed of 10 dots. The first 7 dots are connected by a solid white stroke. The last 3 dots are unconnected. To the right of the 'S' is the word 'pectrea' in a bold, white, sans-serif font, all contained within a black rectangular box.

The gradient lives in the mark only. No gradient-filled wordmark, no full-spectrum lockup — the wordmark is always solid so it stays legible at every size. Duets (Balanced / Warm) belong to the static mark only; they are not lockup options.

## Mark colour modes

- `'color'` — full spectrum (Cobalt → Teal → Amber). Default for `AnimatedLogo`. Used for hero moments.
- `'cool'` — Cool Duet (Cobalt → Teal). Default for `StaticLogo`. Primary static mark for everyday use.
- `'balanced'` — Balanced Duet (Teal → #6FB884 at 65% → Amber). For product/ecosystem moments.

- 'warm' — Warm Duet (Amber → Rose). For marketing attention.
- 'grey' — Pewter. Watermarks only.
- 'white' — Canvas #FDFDFB . Dark backgrounds.
- 'ink' — Ink #18181C . Formal, co-branding, single-colour print.

## Dot-colour rule

- **Mono mode** ( ink / white / grey ) → dots match the mark — not grey.
- **Gradient/duet mode** → dots are grey ( #A3A3A3 ). This is the primary brand treatment.
- **Exception:** the intentional "Ink + Grey Dots" variant labelled *Quiet authority* — connection formed, spectrum dormant.

## Variants (11 approved)

### On light backgrounds:

1. Primary mark (Cool Duet, grey dots)
2. Primary lockup
3. Ink mark
4. Ink lockup
5. Grey mark (watermark only)

**On dark backgrounds:** 6. Primary on dark (Cool Duet + grey dots) 7. Primary lockup on dark 8. White mark 9. White lockup

**Contained (below 48px):** 10. Ink circle (white mark on ink fill) 11. White circle (ink mark on white fill)

## Lockup arrangements (three)

1. **Gradient logotype** — LogotypeGradient . Preferred for brand/marketing.
2. **Horizontal with descriptor** — StaticLogo + lowercase pectrea wordmark + descriptor below. For nav, product headers, sub-brands. Descriptor styling: gap-3 between mark and wordmark column, text-xs , uppercase, tracking-widest, Pewter ( #97979E ).
3. **Stacked** — mark above wordmark. For title slides, centered compositions. Wordmark width ≤ mark width.

## When to use which variant

| Context                | Variant             | Why                                      |
|------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Website header (light) | Logotype            | Preferred horizontal treatment           |
| Website header (dark)  | Logotype (white)    | White logotype on dark                   |
| Product sidebar / nav  | #1 + descriptor     | Primary mark with descriptor             |
| Favicon (16–32px)      | #10                 | Ink circle — high contrast small         |
| App icon               | #10                 | Bold, distinctive in app grids           |
| Social avatar          | #10                 | Circular crop on most platforms          |
| Social cover image     | #2 or #7            | Full lockup, match cover background      |
| Marketing hero         | Logotype or stacked | Logotype inline; stacked centered        |
| Co-branding            | #3 or #4            | Ink prevents colour competition          |
| Legal / formal         | #4                  | Ink lockup — authoritative, max contrast |
| Watermark              | #5 at low opacity   | Grey mark, subtle                        |
| Emboss / foil stamp    | #3                  | Single-tone production                   |

## Clear space

Minimum clear space around the lockup = 0.5× the mark height. No other graphic element (text, border, background image) enters the clear-space box.

## Misuse

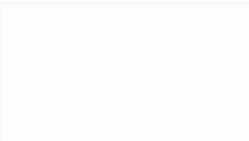
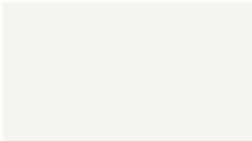
Never: stretch or distort · change colours (spectrum gradient is Cobalt → Teal → Amber; never substitute) · rotate · add drop shadows, glows, bevels · use only the stroke path without dots · use on low-contrast backgrounds (< 2.5:1) · change dot count (always exactly 10) · swap mark and wordmark positions · violate clear space · use a squircle container (always round) · colour the dots in the primary treatment · substitute the wordmark typeface.

## 5. Colour System

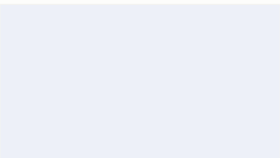
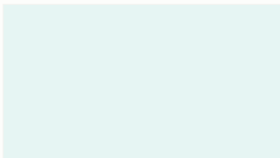
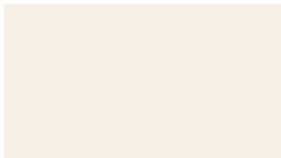
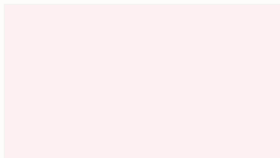
### SPECTRUM ACCENTS

|                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                    |                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  |  |  |  |
| <b>Cobalt</b><br>#4271DF                                                          | <b>Teal</b><br>#00B6A0                                                            | <b>Amber</b><br>#E19000                                                            | <b>Rose</b><br>#F24260                                                              |

### WARM BLEND NEUTRALS

|                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                    |                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  |  |  |  |  |
| <b>Canvas</b><br>#FDFDFB                                                          | <b>Cloud</b><br>#F4F4F1                                                           | <b>Pewter</b><br>#97979E                                                          | <b>Graphite</b><br>#212226                                                         | <b>Ink</b><br>#18181C                                                               |

### BRIDGE TIER (TINTED WASHES)

|                                                                                    |                                                                                    |                                                                                     |                                                                                      |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  |  |  |  |
| <b>Cobalt Wash</b><br>#EDF0F8                                                      | <b>Teal Mist</b><br>#E6F5F3                                                        | <b>Amber Stone</b><br>#F5F0E6                                                       | <b>Rose Blush</b><br>#FDF0F2                                                         |

### Warm Blend neutrals (applied system-wide)

A subtle warm tint layered under the spectrum — closes the gap between cold Tailwind grays and the warm accents. Luminance shift is <2% but cohesive as a system.

| Role                        | Name     | Hex     | CSS var          |
|-----------------------------|----------|---------|------------------|
| Background                  | Canvas   | #FDFDFB | --color-canvas   |
| Elevated surface            | Cloud    | #F4F4F1 | --color-cloud    |
| Muted / secondary text      | Pewter   | #97979E | --color-pewter   |
| Dark UI surface             | Graphite | #212226 | --color-graphite |
| Primary text / dark surface | Ink      | #18181C | --color-ink      |



## Spectrum accents (the four spectrum colours)

| Role              | Name   | Hex     | Meaning                                                     |
|-------------------|--------|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Hero / primary    | Cobalt | #4271DF | Intelligence, trust, focus. One primary action per section. |
| Positive / growth | Teal   | #00B6A0 | Success, growth, connected status.                          |
| Attention         | Amber  | #E19000 | Warnings, pending, confidence.                              |
| Urgency / action  | Rose   | #F24260 | Errors, destructive actions, critical alerts.               |

Hover/active states for each accent:

- Cobalt: base #4271DF , hover #3A63C4 , active #3255A7 .
- Teal: base #00B6A0 , hover #009E8A , active #008775 .
- Amber: base #E19000 , hover #C58200 , active #A86E00 .
- Rose: base #F24260 , hover #D63B55 , active #BA3249 .

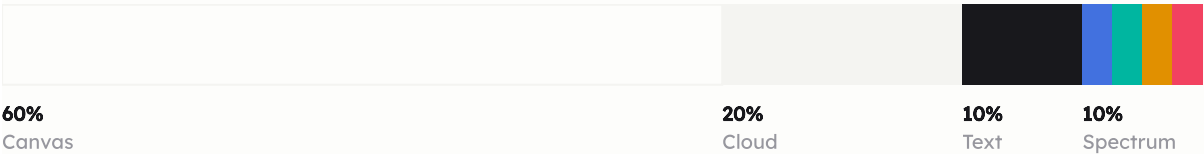
## Bridge tier (tinted washes)

Tiered between the neutral canvas and the vivid accents — 5–10% saturation versions of each spectrum colour. Always carry semantic meaning; never decorative.

| Name        | Hex     | Paired accent | Use                                     |
|-------------|---------|---------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Cobalt Wash | #EDF0F8 | Cobalt        | Info alert background, selected row     |
| Teal Mist   | #E6F5F3 | Teal          | Success toast, positive trend card      |
| Amber Stone | #F5F0E6 | Amber         | Warning alert, highlighted callout      |
| Rose Blush  | #FDF0F2 | Rose          | Error message, destructive confirmation |

## Colour ratio (the 60/20/10/10 rule)

- **60%** Canvas (page background)
- **20%** Cloud (elevated surfaces: cards, sidebars, dropdowns)
- **10%** Ink + Pewter (text and UI)
- **10%** Spectrum accents (semantic moments only)



## Tiered colour framework

Every colour in Spectrea lives in one of three tiers:

1. **Tier 1 — Responsive (Cobalt)**. Action-oriented elements — things that trigger an operation. Temporary and reactive: present during hover, focus, press, then settles. Primary buttons, links, CTAs, input focus, hovered icons.
2. **Tier 2 — Structural (Ink)**. Persistent state and navigation. Active nav item, selected tab, toggled-on icon, current breadcrumb. Ink keeps the canvas calm while Cobalt stays reserved for action.
3. **Tier 3 — Semantic (spectrum + Pewter)**. The system communicating status. Info (Cobalt), success (Teal), warning (Amber), error (Rose). Never decorative — every appearance carries meaning.

## 6. Gradients

Three gradients — don't conflate them.

### Primary brand gradient (the default)

**Cobalt** → **Teal** → **Amber** at 135°, interpolated in **OKLCH** on modern browsers with a clean sRGB fallback. This is the everyday brand gradient — hero sections, accent bars, dividers, decorative strips, progress indicators.



#### Brand gradient

`linear-gradient(135deg in oklch, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000)` — sRGB fallback

### Cross-browser CSS recipe

```
.brand-gradient {  
  background: linear-gradient(135deg, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000);  
}  
@supports (background: linear-gradient(in oklch, red, blue)) {  
  .brand-gradient {  
    background: linear-gradient(135deg in oklch, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000);  
  }  
}
```

The `@supports` block is silently ignored by browsers that don't understand OKLCH (Chrome <111, Safari <16.2, Firefox <117) — they keep the sRGB base. Modern browsers apply the OKLCH override for a perceptually richer middle that avoids the muddy olive zone.

## Lockup mark gradient (inside LogotypeGradient only)

Two-tone Cool Duet — the same gradient as the primary static mark. The wordmark stays monotone (Ink / White); only the mark carries colour.

0% #4271DF → 100% #00B6A0

Implemented in SVG ( `<linearGradient>` ). **Never used as a general-purpose decorative gradient.**



### Lockup mark gradient — LogotypeGradient only, Cool Duet

0% #4271DF → 100% #00B6A0 (wordmark stays monotone Ink / White)

## Full spectrum with Rose (sparingly)

Cobalt → Teal → Amber → Rose at 135°. Use only for peak brand expression — landing-page heroes, launch moments. Reserving it keeps its impact.



### Full spectrum with Rose — marketing only, use sparingly

#4271DF → #00B6A0 → #E19000 → #F24260

## Two-colour duets (adjacent pairs only)

Must use **adjacent** spectrum pairs. Skip pairs (Cobalt → Amber direct, Teal → Rose, Cobalt → Rose) break the continuous-spectrum metaphor and are off-brand.

- **Cool Duet** — Cobalt → Teal. Intelligence + growth. The resting-state duet. Used by the static S mark and data/technical contexts.
- **Balanced Duet** — Teal → #6FB884 at 65% → Amber. *Must* include the #6FB884 intermediate; without it, teal and amber desaturate into muddy olive. For product/ecosystem moments.
- **Warm Duet** — Amber → Rose. Energy + urgency. Marketing, launches, attention.



### Cool Duet — intelligence + growth

#4271DF → #00B6A0



#### Balanced Duet — must include #6FB884 bridge

#00B6A0 → #6FB884 (65%) → #E19000



#### Warm Duet — energy + urgency

#E19000 → #F24260

### Gradient rules

- **Use for:** logo mark background, hero accent bars, marketing page headers, loading progress bars, slide deck title dividers, social media profile accents.
- **Never for:** buttons (use solid Cobalt), text colour, body backgrounds, borders, small icons or badges, repeated elements.

## 7. Typography

# We connect the dots.

ALBERT SANS BOLD 700 · 32px · Display / Hero

## Knowledge, connected.

ALBERT SANS SEMIBOLD 600 · 22px · H2 / Section heading

Every document you upload enriches your knowledge graph.

LEXEND REGULAR 400 · 16px · Body

`entity.type: "Financial Model" | confidence: 0.94`

JETBRAINS MONO REGULAR 400 · 13px · Code / Metadata

Type system (three typefaces)

| Role            | Family         | Weights                                               | Use                                                     |
|-----------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Headings        | Albert Sans    | 600 (Semibold), 700 (Bold — logo wordmark, hero only) | Page titles, section headings, card titles, stat values |
| Body            | Lexend         | 300, 400, 500                                         | Body text, descriptions, form labels, nav items         |
| Code / metadata | JetBrains Mono | 400                                                   | Inline code, data values, entity types, provenance      |

Type scale

|                                 |                        |
|---------------------------------|------------------------|
| Display                         | 48px · line 1.1        |
| Heading 1                       | 36px · line 1.2        |
| Heading 2                       | 30px · line 1.25       |
| Heading 3                       | 24px · line 1.3        |
| Body Large — leading paragraphs | 18px · line 1.6        |
| Body — default paragraphs       | 16px · line 1.6        |
| Body SM — secondary text        | 14px · line 1.5        |
| Caption — labels, timestamps    | 12px · line 1.5        |
| OVERLINE — SECTION LABELS       | 12px · 0.05em tracking |
| code · data values · 0.94       | 14px · mono            |

| Size     | Value | Line height | Weight | Use                                          |
|----------|-------|-------------|--------|----------------------------------------------|
| Display  | 48 px | 1.1         | 600    | Hero headlines, landing-page titles          |
| H1       | 36 px | 1.2         | 600    | Page titles                                  |
| H2       | 30 px | 1.25        | 600    | Major section headings                       |
| H3       | 24 px | 1.3         | 600    | Sub-section headings, card titles            |
| H4       | 20 px | 1.4         | 600    | Minor headings, dialog titles                |
| H5       | 18 px | 1.4         | 600    | Sidebar section titles                       |
| Body LG  | 18 px | 1.6         | 400    | Lead paragraphs                              |
| Body     | 16 px | 1.6         | 400    | Default body text                            |
| Body SM  | 14 px | 1.5         | 400    | Secondary text, table cells, form inputs     |
| Caption  | 12 px | 1.5         | 500    | Labels, timestamps, helper text              |
| Overline | 12 px | 1.5         | 600    | Section labels (uppercase + 0.05em tracking) |

## Responsive scale

Desktop (1024+) / Tablet (640–1023) / Mobile (<640):

- Display: 48 / 36 / 30
- H1: 36 / 30 / 24
- H2: 30 / 24 / 20
- H3: 24 / 20 / 18
- Body / Body SM: unchanged across breakpoints.

## Accessibility

- Body text minimum: 16 px. Never lower for primary content.
- Contrast ratio minimum: 4.5:1. Ink on Canvas  $\approx$  17.6:1. Pewter on Canvas  $\approx$  3.1:1 (decorative only).
- Never rely on colour alone — pair colour coding with icons, patterns, or labels.
- Layout must not break at 200% browser text-zoom.

## 8. Iconography

**Library:** Tabler Icons ( `react-icons/tb` — outline + filled from one library).

### Specs:

- Style: outline by default; filled only for active/selected states.
- Stroke width: 2 px (Tabler default, consistent across all icons).
- Stroke caps/joins: round (matches the brand's warm personality).
- Grid: 24×24 px.
- Padding: 2 px inset — content stays within a 20 px live area.

### Colour system (tiered):

- **Ink** ( #18181C ) — primary: nav, headings, actions.
- **Pewter** ( #97979E ) — secondary: helpers, disabled, muted.
- **Cobalt** ( #4271DF ) — active state, selected, links (hover responsive).
- **Cloud** ( #F4F4F1 ) — on dark backgrounds.

**Rule:** never use spectrum accents (Teal, Amber, Rose) for decorative icons. Those colours are reserved for semantic meaning.

## 9. Illustration

Spectrea runs a **dual visual language**. Iconography and product UI stay strictly geometric (Section 8). Illustration — for marketing pages, blog posts, fundraising decks, social, and brand storytelling — is warmer, richer, and allows more organic composition. Both tiers share the same palette so they read as one brand.

### Tier A — Product / docs (strict geometric)

Already defined by Sections 5–8. Flat primitives, no gradients, strict palette. Used for: app UI, iconography, technical diagrams, developer documentation, changelogs, status pages.

### Tier B — Marketing / editorial (warmer illustrated)

For everything people-facing and narrative. Characterised by:

- **Filled shapes only** — no outlines, no borders, no line art
- **Mixed shape vocabulary** — basic geometric primitives (circles, rectangles, triangles, arcs) for structured subjects + organic curved shapes (flowing foliage, rounded hills, billowy clouds, soft contours) for natural / soft subjects
- **Tints of primaries** — 20–60% opacity versions of Cobalt, Teal, Amber, Rose for supporting elements, mid-ground, atmospheric depth. Every element carries colour; no large empty neutral areas
- **Subtle depth** — soft vertical gradient permitted on background fields only; single darker tonal step on rounded organic objects; atmospheric perspective for recessed elements

- **Figures** — clean silhouette, flat-block clothing in palette colours, suggested face only. No detailed facial features
- **Balanced composition** — visual weight and colour distributed across the frame; asymmetric balance via rule-of-thirds or diagonal flow; element count fits the subject (rich but uncluttered)

**Reference aesthetic:** Linear.app and Stripe brand illustrations — warm, composed, full of life, clean.

## Production workflow

1. Generate with a free + commercial-safe AI tool (Gemini, Bing Image Creator / DALL-E 3, Adobe Firefly, or Stable Diffusion locally) using the locked prompt template
2. Vectorise the raster output with **Inkscape** (Path → Trace Bitmap → Multiple scans → Colors)
3. Drop the SVG into `/public/illustrations/`, or paste markup into a React component
4. Snap fills to exact Spectrea hex codes, namespace IDs, clean up excess paths

**Prompt template:** versioned at `docs/illustration-prompt.md` in the repo (internal, not served publicly). Keep that file as the single source of truth — edit there, not here.

## What Tier B never does

- Outlines, strokes, borders, line art
- Photorealism, 3D rendering, isometric projection
- Drop shadows, glows, lens flares
- Heavy textures, noise, grain, hatching
- Off-brand colours (neon, magenta, cyan, bright yellow, pastel pink, purple, lavender, bright green)
- Detailed facial features — suggested shapes only
- Mascot characters, anthropomorphic objects
- Overcrowded scenes



## When to use which tier

| Surface                               | Tier                 |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------|
| App UI, iconography                   | A — strict geometric |
| Technical diagrams, dashboards        | A                    |
| Developer docs, changelogs            | A                    |
| Marketing website                     | B — illustrated      |
| Blog / editorial                      | B                    |
| Fundraising / sales deck              | B                    |
| Social posts                          | B                    |
| Onboarding / product tour hero images | B (with restraint)   |

## 10. Motion

### Philosophy

Purposeful, subtle, natural. Every animation answers "what does this help the user understand?" — if the answer is "nothing," remove it. Motion guides attention, confirms actions, and creates continuity; it never decorates.

### Durations

- 100 ms — micro (hover tints, colour shifts)
- 150 ms — standard (UI transitions, dropdowns)
- 200 ms — comfortable (modals, slide-overs)
- 300 ms — deliberate (page transitions, choreographed sequences)

### Easing

- `ease-out (cubic-bezier(0, 0, 0.2, 1))` — default for things entering or settling.
- `ease-in-out (cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1))` — for back-and-forth movements, continuous animations.
- Never use linear (feels mechanical) or ease-in alone (feels like something is wrong).

## Animated mark

The Spectrea mark animates on a 3-second loop: the spectrum stroke draws along the S curve, pauses, then dissolves to reveal the dots again. Always uses the **full spectrum** (Cobalt → Teal → Amber) — the "reveal" moment. Use for loading states, hero animations, and motion assets.

## 11. Components

### Buttons

- **Primary (Cobalt)** — the hero action. One per section. `#4271DF`, white text; hover `#3A63C4`; active `#3255A7`.
- **Secondary** — supporting actions. Cloud (`#F4F4F1`) background, Ink text (light); Graphite tint background, Cloud text (dark).
- **Ghost** — tertiary actions. 2-px border, transparent background.
- **Destructive (Rose)** — irreversible actions. `#F24260`, white text.
- **Confirm (Teal)** — verify, approve, connect. `#00B6A0`, white text.
- **Caution (Amber)** — override, merge, proceed. `#E19000`, white text.

Common specs: padding `px-4 py-2` (default), radius `8 px` (rounded-lg), font `Lexend 500`, font-size `14 px`.

Focus ring: Amber `rgba(225, 144, 0, 0.7)` (alpha-tinted `#E19000`), 2 px solid, 2 px offset (`.btn-focus:focus-visible`).

### Forms

Input fields: `1 px` border (Tailwind `stone-200` ≈ Cloud-adjacent), `8 px` radius, `px-3 py-2` padding, `14 px` Lexend. On focus: `2 px` Cobalt border, no separate shadow ring. Placeholder colour: Pewter.

### Cards

Container: `1 px` border (Tailwind `stone-200`), `12 px` radius (rounded-xl), `20 px` padding (p-5), Canvas background. Elevated variant adds `shadow-md` (floating elements only). Cards sit on the Cloud surface — the Canvas-vs-Cloud contrast gives them "home."

### Layout

- **Sidebar**: 256 px fixed width, collapsible on mobile.
- **Top bar**: 40–48 px height. Search + user menu.
- **Content area**: fluid, scrollable, Cloud (`#F4F4F1`) background.

- **Breakpoints:** mobile <640 px (1 column), tablet 640–1023 (2 cols), desktop 1024–1279 (3 cols), wide 1280+ (4 cols).
- **Base spacing unit:** 4 px. All spacing values are multiples of 4.

## 12. Communications

### Voice in action

Every piece of written output — product copy, email, social, presentation slides — follows the same voice formula: clear, specific, warm. Technical language is welcomed when it earns its place (“graph architecture” is fine; “leveraging our graph-based RAG pipeline for vector embeddings” is not).

### Email

- **Signature:** Logotype at `fontSize=11`, `colorMode="ink"`, `color="#212226"`, followed by “| We connect the dots.”
- **Transactional header:** LogotypeGradient at `fontSize=13` on Canvas.
- **Marketing header (dark):** LogotypeGradient at `fontSize=13` on Ink. No `wordmarkColor` override.
- **Body typography:** Lexend 400, 16 px, Ink on Canvas.

### Social media

- **Avatar:** gradient mark at 400×400 px (square, no crop).
- **Cover images:** brand gradient bar + tagline on Ink background (LinkedIn); gradient bar at bottom with tagline centered (Twitter/X).
- **Bio template:** “We connect the dots. Composable knowledge platform.”
- **Quote card:** Ink background, Cloud text, `h-1` brand gradient accent strip at bottom.
- **Stat card:** Ink background, 3 xl Cloud number, Pewter supporting text, gradient accent strip at bottom.

### Presentations

- **Canvas slide background:** Canvas ( `#FDFDFB` ).
- **Ink slide background:** Ink ( `#18181C` ) — for divider / emphasis slides.
- **Title typography:** Albert Sans 600, 48 px.
- **Body typography:** Lexend 400, 24 px.
- **Accent strip:** brand gradient, 4 px tall, at the bottom of title slides.
- **Footer:** Logotype at `fontSize=9`, `colorMode="ink"`, `color="#97979E"`.

## 13. Governance

### The simple test

If you need to ask "is this OK?" — it probably isn't. The logo should always look exactly like the approved versions on the Variations page. When in doubt, use the primary treatment (grey dots, Cool-Duet stroke) on Canvas — that's always correct.

### Change process

1. **Propose** — document what you want to change and why.
2. **Review** — design lead + brand lead sign off.
3. **Version** — bump this guide and the related code.
4. **Communicate** — change log posted in `#brand`.

### Owner

Brand lead owns this document. Updates live here; downstream consumers (Figma library, Tailwind config, PDF export) are regenerated from this as source of truth.

## 14. Resources

### CSS tokens

```
:root {  
  /* Spectrum */  
  --color-brand: #4271DF;  
  --color-brand-teal: #00B6A0;  
  --color-brand-amber: #E19000;  
  --color-brand-rose: #F24260;  
  
  /* Warm Blend neutrals */  
  --color-canvas: #FDFDFB;  
  --color-cloud: #F4F4F1;  
  --color-pewter: #97979E;  
  --color-graphite: #212226;  
  --color-ink: #18181C;  
  
  /* Typography */  
  --font-heading: 'Albert Sans', sans-serif;  
  --font-body: 'Lexend', 'Inter', sans-serif;  
  --font-mono: 'JetBrains Mono', monospace;
```

```
/* Radii */
--radius-lg: 8px;
--radius-xl: 12px;
}

/* Brand gradient — OKLCH with sRGB fallback */
.brand-gradient {
  background: linear-gradient(135deg, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000);
}
@supports (background: linear-gradient(in oklch, red, blue)) {
  .brand-gradient {
    background: linear-gradient(135deg in oklch, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000);
  }
}
```

## Icon library

Tabler Icons via `react-icons/tb` — outline and filled from one library. 2 px stroke, round caps/joins, 24×24 grid.

## Fonts

All via Google Fonts:

- [Albert Sans](#) (weights 600, 700)
- [Lexend](#) (weights 300, 400, 500)
- [JetBrains Mono](#) (weight 400)

*This document is the single source of truth for the Spectrea brand. The live web version at [spectrea.com/brand](https://spectrea.com/brand) contains interactive demos and the asset generator. If this document and the web guide ever disagree, this document wins.*